

Stelios Zarifis

Emails: Personal – stelios.zarifis@gmail.com, Work – s.zarifis@athenarc.gr | Phone: +30 6942 575 875

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/stelios-zarifis](https://www.linkedin.com/in/stelios-zarifis) | GitHub: github.com/SteliosZarifis

Personal page: stelioszarifis.github.io

Education

M. Eng. in Electrical and Computer Engineering, Major in Computer Science 2020 – 2025
National Technical University of Athens (NTUA), School of ECE, Athens, Greece

- Graduation grade: 8.78 / 10
- M. Eng. Thesis: *Decision-Making in Stochastic Environments Using Diffusion Models*
Advisor: Prof. Petros Maragos
- Key Directions: Machine Learning, Generative Models, Reinforcement Learning, Control

High School (Lyceum), 2nd General Lyceum of Chalandri 2016 – 2019
Graduation grade: 19.2 / 20

Research Experience

PhD Candidate (HERON-CoE Fellow): School of ECE, NTUA 2025/11 – Present

- Developmental & Multi-Modal Artificial Intelligence
- Self & World Modeling for Robotic Systems
- Participation in the EU PILLAR-Robots project.

Researcher: HERON-CoE & Athena Research Center 2025/07 – 2025/10

- Developmental & Multi-Modal Artificial Intelligence

Undergraduate Research Fellow: Athena Research Center 2025/01 – 2025/06

- Stochastic System Optimization using Diffusion Models

Reviewer: IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (ICASSP 2026)

- Technical paper reviewer

Reviewer Assistant: IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA 2026)

- Assist in review under supervision of postdoctoral researcher

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant: School of ECE, National Technical University of Athens 2025/11 – Present

- Machine Learning Course

Publications

- S. Zarifis, I. Kordonis, and P. Maragos, “Diffusion-Based Scenario Tree Generation for Multivariate Time Series Prediction and Multistage Stochastic Optimization”. **Accepted** to the IEEE European Signal Processing Conference (EUSIPCO).
- S. Zarifis, I. Kordonis, and P. Maragos, “Diffusion-Based Forecasting for Uncertainty-Aware Model Predictive Control” in 2025 33rd European Signal Processing Conference (EUSIPCO), Palermo, Italy, 2025, pp. 1877–1881.
- S. Zarifis, et al. “Baby Sophia: A Developmental Approach to Self-Exploration through Self-Touch and Hand Regard” (2025), for the *IEEE International Conference on Development and Learning (ICDL 2025)*, BabyBench Competition.

Conferences

- 2025/09 IEEE EUSIPCO – Poster Presentation.
- 2025/09 IEEE ICDL – Competition Participation.
- 2025/07 Greeks in AI Symposium – Poster Presentation.
- 2023/06 IEEE ICASSP – Attendance.

Seminars

- 2022/02 Unmanned Air Systems Common Module, HAFA & European Security & Defense College

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, Matlab, R

Machine Learning: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-Learn, Keras, OpenCV, Torchvision

Reinforcement Learning: IsaacLab, OpenAI Gym, Stable Baselines

Optimization: Gurobi, CVXPY, SciPy

Time Series: GluonTS, PyTorchTS, MATLAB

Data Analysis: NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn

Languages

Greek: Native

English: TOEFL iBT (12/2024) | Certificate of Proficiency in English, University of Michigan (2016)

Awards

- **PhD Research Fellowship**, Hellenic Robotics Center of Excellence & Athena Research Center 2025
- **Undergraduate Research Fellowship**, Athena Research Center 2025
- **D. Thomaidis Publication Award**, NTUA 2025
- **Top School Score in National Panhellenic Examinations**, 2nd Lyceum of Chalandri 2019
- **Commendation for Academic Excellence in High School**, Gymnasium & Lyceum 2012 – 2018

Competitions

- 2025 Participation in “AI and the Ocean” hackathon, Institut Français de Grèce & Athena RC.
- 2025 Participation in IEEE ICDL BabyBench Competition.
- 2014–2017 Participation in Hellenic Mathematical Society Competitions *Euclid* and *Thales*.
- 2015 Participation in the 33rd National Mathematical Olympiad “Archimedes”.
- 2011–2012 Participation in Hellenic Mathematical Society *Little Euclid* Competitions.

Memberships

- IEEE | IEEE Computer Society Member | IEEE Robotics & Automation Society Member
- AAAI Member
- EURASIP Member

Volunteering

- European Researcher’s Night
- Athens Science Festival
- Race for the Cure & blood/hair donation